

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

STOP CALLING THAT ROOM A BEDROOM.

If a buyer can't climb out the window in a fire, it isn't one.

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**5.7 SQUARE FEET.
THAT'S THE
NUMBER THAT
DECIDES
"BEDROOM."**

The 2024 building code sets an exact egress size.
Most listings never check it.

THE CODE HAS A NUMBER. MOST LISTINGS SKIP IT.

The 2024 International Residential Code, Section R310, sets the exact test for a legal bedroom: an emergency escape window with a net clear opening of at least 5.7 square feet, a minimum opening height of 24 inches, and a minimum opening width of 20 inches. Sections R304 and R303 add a minimum floor area of 70 square feet, with at least 7 feet in any horizontal direction, and a heat source capable of holding 68 degrees (a space heater does not count). A finished-basement fourth bedroom with no window, or a converted attic nook with a door and nothing else, fails that test before an appraiser or a lender ever gets involved. Calling it a bedroom anyway doesn't change the code. It just moves the correction from the listing to the closing table.

BEFORE YOU LIST THE "EXTRA BEDROOM":

- 1 Measure the window opening yourself.**
Under 5.7 square feet, or under 24 by 20 inches, it fails egress. No exceptions for a nice room.
- 2 Check the floor area and the heat source.**
Under 70 square feet, no permanent heat, or no 7-foot dimension anywhere in the room, it isn't a legal bedroom either way.
- 3 If it fails, use the honest word.**
Den, flex room, office, or bonus room. If it's close, say "easily converted to a fourth bedroom" instead of miscounting now.

THE TAKEAWAY

CALL IT A BEDROOM, AND THE BUYER FINDS OUT AT INSPECTION.

Use the room's real word and let the number do the selling instead.